

GO-TO-MARKET

The First Ten Customers

How CrossDesk reaches its first customers, drives real settlement volume, and becomes the in-kind fund-issuance and committee-NAV layer for tokenised assets on Canton — without a single cold email.

Distribution is usually the hard part. For CrossDesk it is unusually direct: the customers, the assets, and the network already sit in one dense, builder-hungry ecosystem. The strategy is not "find users" — it is land on the live native assets, drive real volume as a featured app, and become the in-kind fund-issuance and committee-NAV layer the rest of the market marks to.

The ecosystem

is the channel — ~400 institutions, no cold outreach

cETH · CBTC

the wedge: live native assets whose issuers pay builders

Featured-app

network rewards — a live app earns CC from the volume it drives

3 revenue lines

in-kind issuance + committee NAV · per-create/redeem fee · fund-desk SaaS

Land & expand

from cETH/CBTC up to DTCC / Kinexys tokenised Treasuries

CrossDesk — the in-kind fund-issuance and committee-NAV layer for tokenised assets on Canton, built on an atomic settlement engine with a sealed, uniform-price call auction as the price-formation engine underneath.
Prepared July 2026 · Sebastian Borjas · github.com/superbigroach/canton-dvp-settlement-desk

The thesis

CrossDesk's go-to-market is **ecosystem-native, not outbound**. The Canton Network is a dense community of ~400 institutions that is *actively paying builders* to create its app layer (the cETH and CBTC bounties are, literally, asset issuers buying the market structure CrossDesk provides). The plan: land on the live native assets, become the **in-kind fund-issuance and committee-NAV layer** for tokenised assets — deliver underlyings ↔ mint/burn shares atomically, priced by a **K-of-N committee-struck NAV** that no single admin controls, produced by a sealed uniform-price call auction with no front-running — become a **featured app** earning network rewards, and let that issuance-and-NAV layer become the infrastructure issuers build on, then follow the assets up to the institutional tier.

Land on cETH + CBTC → become the in-kind issuance + committee-NAV layer → expand to tokenised funds & Treasuries.

Already built and deployed — not a deck. The full stack ships today: Daml contracts (**18/18 tests green**), a Spring Boot backend over the Ledger API, and a React desk. The Daml package is **deployed to the shared HackCanton devnet node (Canton 3.x)**; the backend connects over TLS + JWT and reads work end-to-end, after a port from Daml 2.9.4 / Ledger API v1 to Canton 3.x / Ledger API v2. Writes are pending a node-operator actAs grant — so it is **deployed and connected on Canton devnet** today, not yet settling live in production.

1 · The channel — how we reach the first ten

No "post on LinkedIn." The distribution paths are warm, specific, and already open:

Channel	Why it works right now
Asset issuers courting builders — onRails (cETH), BitSafe (CBTC)	They are running bounties and office hours to get apps built on their assets. That is a paying customer asking for exactly this product.
HackCanton / AppsFactory — mentors, partners, judges	Direct, warm access to the Foundation, venues, and issuers; a featured project gets platform placement and intros post-hackathon.
Canton venues & wallets — Temple, Bron, C8, Console	They already carry the assets and want differentiated market structure to offer members.
Canton Foundation network — DTCC, Euroclear, Goldman, JPMorgan orbit	A dense institutional community; a working price-formation primitive is a natural referral up the stack.
Founder's institutional network	Direct lines into equities trading and digital-assets teams (incl. an active JPMorgan Digital Assets process) for design-partner feedback.

2 · The first ten — concrete targets

#1–2 · onRails (cETH) & BitSafe (CBTC). Run the first live in-kind create/redeem and NAV auctions on their assets. They want on-chain activity on cETH/CBTC — CrossDesk generates exactly that. Design partners + bounty capital.

#3–5 · Canton venues / wallets (Temple, Bron, C8, Console). Offer the sealed cross as a white-label market-structure feature for the assets they already list.

#6–8 · Emerging tokenised-fund operators on Canton. Run their first on-chain **in-kind create/redeem plus a committee NAV** — the primary-market issuance rail and official mark their tokenised shares run on.

#9–10 · Institutional tier (DTCC tokenised Treasuries, JPMorgan Kinexys MMFs). As these scale on Canton, they need exactly this benchmark; a proven app is the referral.

3 · Business model & the flywheel

Three revenue lines

Who	Pays for
Fund / RWA issuers	Fund-infrastructure-as-a-service — on-chain in-kind issuance (create/redeem) plus a K-of-N committee NAV, the official mark with no single admin (subscription or per-issuance)
Authorised participants / market-makers	Per-create/redeem fee — for atomic, principal-risk-free primary-market access: deliver underlyings ↔ mint/burn shares in one settlement
Venues / custodians	Fund-desk SaaS licence — run a branded, compliant fund desk for members

Plus network rewards: Canton shares ongoing rewards with apps that drive real volume, so a live CrossDesk earns CC from the settlement it generates.

The flywheel

- Run auctions → **real settlement volume**
- Volume → **network rewards** (featured-app CC) *and* an **official price**
- Issuers **mark NAV to the price** → the print gains authority
- An authoritative benchmark **pulls more flow** to the cross
- More flow → more auctions → repeat

First-mover on the benchmark is defensible: once funds mark to a print, switching cost is high.

4 · 30 / 60 / 90-day plan

Window	Goal	Proof point
0–30 days	Desk is already deployed on Canton devnet — run design-partner conversations (onRails, BitSafe) and the first in-kind create/redeem + NAV auction on cETH/CBTC on the live node	First on-ledger in-kind issuance and committee-NAV print with receipts; a named issuer confirms the pain
30–60 days	First tokenised-fund NAV auction pilot; apply for featured-app status; publish a daily print	One operator running a daily private close; featured placement
60–90 days	Recurring auctions + growing volume; add instruments; institutional intros via the Foundation	Repeat volume, network rewards accruing, a pipeline into the institutional tier

5 · Why CrossDesk wins the lane

- **Unoccupied niche.** OTC desks (Swap.Monster) and continuous orderbooks (Silvana) exist on Canton — an **in-kind fund-issuance + committee-NAV layer** (with a sealed call auction as the price engine)

underneath) does not.

- **Already built and deployed.** Not a concept — the full stack is deployed and connected on Canton devnet: Daml contracts (**18/18 tests green**), a Spring Boot backend over the Ledger API v2, and a React desk, ported from Daml 2.9.4 / Ledger API v1 to Canton 3.x.
- **Founder credibility.** Built by a former equities trader who traded the open/close professionally — the exact market microstructure.
- **Canton-native & private by construction.** The sealed book is impossible on transparent chains; CrossDesk is built where it can actually work.
- **First to the primitive.** Whoever produces the trusted in-kind issuance rail and official committee NAV becomes infrastructure — and that position compounds.

Prepared by Sebastian Borjas, July 2026, for the CrossDesk project (HackCanton Season 2). Independent go-to-market brief for evaluation and discussion — not investment advice, an offer, or a solicitation. Named institutions and projects are cited from public sources to illustrate channel and segment context; they are not customers, partners, or endorsers, and no affiliation is implied. Canton and Daml are products of Digital Asset; cETH of onRails; CBTC of BitSafe. Repo: github.com/superbigroach/canton-dvp-settlement-desk